Dentures

Geriatric Dentistry Suggested URL: `/geriatric-dentistry/dentures`

Replacing Missing Teeth for Everyday Comfort

Missing teeth can affect more than the appearance of your smile. They may make chewing difficult, change the way you speak and reduce confidence in everyday situations. Dentures offer a practical way to replace missing teeth and restore important aspects of oral function.

Dentures are custom-made dental appliances designed to replace some or all missing teeth. Depending on your needs, they may be removable and supported by the gums, or designed to fit over remaining teeth or attach to dental implants.

The right denture depends on the number of missing teeth, the condition of the remaining teeth and gums, jawbone changes and your personal preferences.

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Which Type of Denture May Suit You?

Dentures are not one-size-fits-all. The design depends on whether you have lost a few teeth, all teeth in one jaw, or all teeth in both jaws.

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Complete dentures

Replace all teeth in the upper jaw, lower jaw or both. They rest on the oral tissues and are designed to restore appearance and basic chewing function.

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Partial dentures

Replace several missing teeth while using the remaining natural teeth for support and, depending on the design, retention.

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Implant-supported dentures

Attach to dental implants for additional retention and stability. These require assessment of the jawbone, oral health and suitability for implant surgery.

Your dentist can explain the advantages, limitations, maintenance needs and costs of the options suitable for your mouth.

From First Consultation to Your New Denture

Getting dentures involves more than taking an impression. The fit, bite and appearance need to be planned carefully so the appliance works comfortably with your mouth.

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1. Oral health assessment

The dentist checks your gums, remaining teeth, jaw ridge and bite. Any necessary treatment for infection, decay or gum disease is considered before denture fabrication.

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2. Impressions and bite records

Impressions or digital scans may be used to record the shape of your mouth. Bite measurements help establish how the upper and lower teeth should meet.

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3. Denture fabrication and fitting

The denture is made to the planned design. During fitting, the dentist checks its comfort, appearance, retention and bite, making adjustments where needed.

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4. Review and adjustment

Follow-up appointments help address sore spots, looseness or bite problems. Further adjustments may be needed as you adapt to the denture.

Eating, Speaking and Adjusting to Dentures

A new denture can feel unfamiliar at first. Your mouth may need time to adapt, and speaking or chewing may initially require extra practice.

To make the transition easier:

- Start with softer foods cut into small pieces.

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- Chew slowly and try to distribute food evenly on both sides.

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- Practice reading aloud if your speech feels different.

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- Follow your dentist's advice about wearing the denture during the adjustment period.

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- Return for adjustments if the denture rubs, causes persistent soreness or feels unstable.

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Dentures can improve chewing and appearance, but they may not provide the same sensation or biting efficiency as natural teeth. Implant-supported options may offer additional stability for suitable patients.

Daily Denture Care: Protecting Your Mouth and Appliance

Keeping dentures clean helps reduce plaque, food deposits, odour and irritation of the oral tissues.

- Remove and clean removable dentures daily using a denture brush and a suitable denture-cleaning product.

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- Avoid using hot or boiling water, which may distort some denture materials.

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- Clean your gums, tongue and any remaining natural teeth gently.

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- Remove dentures at night unless your dentist has advised otherwise.

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- Store dentures according to the manufacturer's and dentist's instructions so they do not dry out or become damaged.

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- Keep regular dental appointments, even if you wear complete dentures.

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Never try to repair a cracked denture or adjust its fit yourself. A damaged or poorly fitting appliance should be assessed professionally.

When Should Dentures Be Checked or Replaced?

The shape of the gums and jawbone can change over time, which may affect how dentures fit. A denture that once felt comfortable may gradually become loose or cause sore areas.

Arrange a dental review if you notice:

- A denture slipping while talking or eating.

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- Repeated sore spots or ulcers beneath the appliance.

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- Cracks, broken teeth or damaged clasps.

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- Changes in your bite or difficulty chewing.

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- Persistent mouth irritation, redness or an unpleasant smell.

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Depending on the condition, the dentist may recommend an adjustment, relining, repair or replacement. Regular examinations also help identify problems involving the gums, remaining teeth and oral tissues.

Frequently Asked Questions

1. What is the difference between complete and partial dentures?

Complete dentures replace all teeth in an upper or lower jaw, while partial dentures replace some missing teeth when natural teeth remain.

2. Are dentures comfortable to wear?

Well-made, properly fitted dentures can become comfortable with time. Some initial adjustment is common, but persistent pain or sores should be assessed by your dentist.

3. Can I eat normally with dentures?

Dentures can help restore chewing function. Start with softer foods and progress gradually as you adapt. Some foods may still be harder to chew than with natural teeth.

4. How long do dentures last?

Their lifespan varies depending on the material, wear, maintenance, and changes in your mouth. Regular reviews help determine when adjustment or replacement is needed.

5. Should I remove my dentures at night?

Most removable dentures should be taken out at night to allow the oral tissues to rest, unless your dentist gives different instructions for your particular situation.

6. Can dentures be used if I have no natural teeth?

Yes. Complete dentures can replace all teeth in a jaw. Implant-supported dentures may also be an option for suitable patients after an assessment.

7. What should I do if my dentures become loose?

Arrange a dental appointment. Changes in the jaw ridge can affect the fit, and the dentist can determine whether adjustment, relining or replacement is appropriate. Avoid relying on household adhesives or attempting repairs yourself.

Restore Everyday Comfort with Denture Care at Jerush

Missing teeth should not prevent you from enjoying meals, speaking comfortably or feeling confident about your smile. With the right design, fitting and follow-up care, dentures can be an effective option for restoring your oral function.

At Jerush Dentofacial & Cosmetic Laser Centre, a dental consultation can help identify the most suitable tooth-replacement options based on your oral health, comfort and individual needs.

Considering dentures or struggling with an existing denture? Book a dental consultation to discuss your options.

Add Dr Bladbin image here

SEO recommendations

- SEO title: Dentures for Missing Teeth | Geriatric Dentistry at Jerush
- Meta description: Explore complete, partial and implant-supported dentures for missing teeth. Learn about fitting, daily care, adjustment and maintenance at Jerush.
- Primary keyword: Dentures
- Related keywords: Complete dentures, partial dentures, removable dentures, dentures for older adults, denture fitting and care
- Suggested image alt text: `Custom-fitted dentures for replacing missing teeth and restoring chewing function`